

The `sorted()` function returns a copy of a list in a natural sorted order. The order of the original list is not affected:

```
>>> vowels = ['a', 'i', 'e', 'u', 'o']
>>> sorted(vowels)
['a', 'e', 'i', 'o', 'u']
>>> vowels
['a', 'i', 'e', 'u', 'o']
```

To sort a list, use the `sort()` method:

```
>>> vowels.sort()
>>> vowels
['a', 'e', 'i', 'o', 'u']
```

To put a numerical list in order, use any sorting function:

```
>>> nums = [1, 3, 2, 5]
>>> sorted(nums)
[1, 2, 3, 5]
```